Shuler, Justin Vernard

Software Engineer–DevSecOps (DevSecOps)

Manager: Seshadri Krishnaswamy (3246714)

Evaluated by: Seshadri Krishnaswamy (3246714)

Complete 2025 Year-End Feedback

Organization: Cloud DSO & Services (Seshadri Krishnaswamy (3246714))

Location: USA - Fayetteville, GA

01/01/2025 - 12/31/2025

Manager

Rating: 2 - Successfully Met Expectations / 1 - Inconsistently or Does Not Demonstrate Our Values

Comment: Justin demonstrated developing proficiency in routine sustainment tasks. However, he should strengthen consistency, communication, dependability, and technical independence to meet expectations more broadly. With deliberate focus on follow-through, clarity of execution, and more structured problem-solving, he can build a stronger foundation for future performance.

Acknowledgement

Manager

Entered by: Seshadri Krishnaswamy (3246714) **Date:** 01/26/2026

Status: I acknowledge that I've held the 2025 Year-End Feedback conversation with the employee.

Comment:

Employee

Entered by: Justin Shuler (3544463) **Date:** 01/26/2026

Status: I acknowledge that my 2025 Year-End Feedback conversation occurred.

Comment:

"What" (Goals)

What are your biggest accomplishments or contributions from the year? Did you meet the goals you established with your manager earlier in the year? (Please note: you can access your prior documents by clicking on the downwards arrow in the pop-up box or you can summarize them here. You also have the option of attaching a document to this form if you prefer to do that instead of filling this section out.)

For help writing accomplishments, use this formula: Action + Task + Results.

- Example: To accelerate the procurement process for avionics components, I proactively collaborated with cross-functional teams including engineering, supply chain, and quality assurance. I initiated weekly coordination meetings to identify bottlenecks and align priorities across departments. By streamlining communication and standardizing order documentation, we reduced order processing time by 15%, which improved project timelines and enhanced supplier responsiveness.

Section Summary

Manager Evaluation

Rating: 2 - Successfully Met Expectations

Comment: During the year, Justin supported standard BSF maintenance activities and routine service desk work, and demonstrated familiarity with several established workflows. He also assisted teammates in areas where he had prior experience, helping clarify steps within standard operating procedures. Compared to the prior year, his execution showed modest improvement, particularly in handling recurring updates and credential rotations.

While these contributions reflect progress, there remains an opportunity for Justin to improve consistency, strengthen first-time quality, and reduce rework. Increasing attention to detail—by fully verifying acceptance criteria, validating outcomes, and ensuring all required steps are completed before marking work as done will help reinforce reliability. Tickets should clearly and accurately reflect the work performed and the final status. Adopting a more structured approach, such as using checklists, documenting intermediate steps, confirming understanding when requirements are unclear, and completing follow-ups without reminders, will help Justin handle non-standard assignments more independently. These improvements will increase reliability, reduce follow-up corrections, and support stronger ownership of end-to-end outcomes.

Employee Evaluation

Comment: This year, I made significant contributions to improving platform reliability, automation, and security within the Boeing Software Factory. I led the Mattermost slice by separating it into its own standalone deployment model, aligning Terraform modules, Helm values, RDS/S3 configurations, and Kubernetes resources with BSF standards. I also strengthened our CI/CD ecosystem by improving scheduled pipelines, resolving several OIDC authentication failures for GitLab runners, and verifying multi-environment deployments across stage, prod, and ops. These changes reduced breakages, improved deployment consistency, and supported smoother automation throughout BSF.

In addition to my technical achievements, I made measurable improvements in how I operate day-to-day. I focused heavily on staying on top of open tasks and follow-ups, keeping my Gitlab queues clean, responding more quickly to asks, and providing clearer updates in GitLab, Mattermost, and meetings so teammates always knew the status of ongoing work. I also improved my communication clarity by summarizing troubleshooting steps, posting root-cause findings, and documenting patterns in areas such as GitLab CI rules, Artifactory proxy issues, IAM/OIDC behavior, and Terraform/RDS debugging reducing repeat questions from the team. I worked consistently on increasing my participation, especially during standups and team discussions, by volunteering updates, asking clarifying questions, and proactively raising concerns when I saw blockers. Alongside this, I invested in upskilling teammates, walking others through CI/CD failures, token rotation processes, Terraform state troubleshooting, proxy validation, and pattern-based repository naming, which helped improve the team's collective technical confidence and speed.

Overall, I feel I met and exceeded my goals by increasing both my technical impact and my

effectiveness as a teammate. My work improved BSF's automation reliability, strengthened software supply chain consistency, reduced access and token-related risks, and supported hundreds of service desk requests related to SonarQube access, proxy validation, IAM role issues, GitLab permissions, and cluster capacity concerns. At the same time, I significantly grew in communication, responsiveness, and ownership staying organized, keeping work visible, and elevating team coordination. I'm proud of the progress I've made and look forward to continuing my development toward a Solutions Architect role while expanding my expertise in AWS, GitLab CI/CD, and platform automation.

"How" (Values & Behaviors)

How do you assess yourself against the Values and Behaviors? How have you demonstrated progress in your identified growth area since mid-year? Provide an additional example of how you demonstrated the Values & Behaviors on an important goal.

Example: My mid-year commitment was to be more collaborative with other departments down the value chain from ours – bringing them in earlier so they can help influence designs and decisions to ultimately improve our partnership and the final product's quality. To do this, I established a biweekly meeting where we discuss upcoming design choices together and give progress updates. In addition to being more collaborative, our new reviews have helped us focus more on the customer's priorities together versus the challenges across department, I've shown ownership by taking the feedback and following through on agreed design suggestions, and we've actually come to some more innovative outcomes as a result of cross-department thinking.

Section Summary

Manager Evaluation

Rating: 1 - Inconsistently or Does Not Demonstrate Our Values

Comment: Justin demonstrated several positive behaviors aligned with Boeing's Values, including effective collaboration with peers and a willingness to support teammates, reflecting strong People Focus.

At the same time, there are core behaviors that need strengthening to ensure expectations are met consistently. Status updates were at times incomplete or missing, and follow-through was uneven, including marking work complete before all required

Employee Evaluation

Comment: This year, I demonstrated Boeing's Values & Behaviors by improving the reliability and quality of several key BSF systems. I upheld Safety & Quality by validating Helm upgrades, correcting broken Ingress host rules, fixing Postgres/RDS endpoint issues affecting applications, and ensuring secure token rotations across pipelines. I showed Trust and Ownership by resolving GitLab runner OIDC failures, SonarQube login issues, proxy misconfigurations, and GitLab access discrepancies that were blocking teams. I

steps were finished, missing checklist actions, delaying acknowledgment or progress on assigned tasks, and missing meetings or discussions. These patterns highlight opportunities for improvement in Ownership, Trust, and Safety & Quality.

Looking ahead, improving the reliability of communication, increasing attention to detail, and taking more proactive ownership of assigned work will help Justin demonstrate Boeing's Values more consistently and support stronger first-time quality outcomes.

demonstrated People Focus by quickly unblocking internal customers facing issues, runner scheduling problems, failed dependency downloads, and other service desk requests. I applied Innovation by improving pipeline logic, standardizing Artifactory proxy definitions, and maintaining the Application Maintenance Tracker for consistent multi-environment deployments. Since mid-year, I made notable progress in my growth area of communication, task follow-through, and participation. I kept my work queue organized, followed up more consistently, and provided clearer status updates in Mattermost and GitLab so teammates always knew what was in progress. I summarized troubleshooting issue that face the BSF support Q caused by taints or errors causing discrepancies so others could learn from the fixes. I also increased engagement during standups and discussions, asked clarifying questions, and volunteered for incoming work, which improved team coordination and transparency.

A strong example of applying Boeing's Values was improving the Mattermost slice and the broader CI/CD ecosystem. For the slice, I demonstrated Safety & Quality by validating Helm values, secrets, and connectivity across environments. For CI/CD more broadly, I showed Ownership by fixing recurring OIDC authentication failures and correcting proxy definitions that caused dependency outages. These efforts combined technical execution with strong communication.

Development Plan

Thinking about the feedback you've received, what steps can you take to build your skills and meet your career goals?

- Click here for guidance on creating a development plan.
- Example: I want to build my leadership skills by helping coordinate the team more. I will also find an experienced manager to mentor me so I can learn how to manage teams and make good decisions.

Section Summary

Manager Evaluation

Employee Evaluation

Comment: In the coming year, Justin should focus on strengthening his foundational technical skills across BSF, AWS, and Kubernetes, while building greater confidence in independently troubleshooting issues. Using a more structured approach to problem-solving, experimenting safely in sandbox environments, and breaking tasks into smaller, manageable components will help him build momentum and confidence when challenges arise. More deliberate use of documentation, hands-on practice, and early validation of his understanding will further support stronger execution and more reliable outcomes.

To improve consistency and better align with organizational expectations, Justin should also prioritize timely communication, consistent meeting attendance, and accurate completion of standard workflows. Establishing a predictable routine, acknowledging assignments promptly, asking clarifying questions early, and providing regular status updates will increase visibility and reduce the need for repeated follow-up. Strengthening attention to detail and verifying work before marking tasks complete will be essential. With sustained effort in these areas, Justin can establish a stronger baseline for both technical capability and professional effectiveness.

Comment: Based on the feedback I've received this year, I am focused on strengthening the skills that align with a Level 2 engineer, especially independent problem solving, broader system understanding, and increasing ownership of work. One step I'm taking is expanding my technical depth across the BSF ecosystem, including GitLab CI/CD architecture, AWS GovCloud services, Kubernetes operations, and Terraform/Helm patterns. In addition, I am enrolling in a Solutions Architect course to better my AWS knowledge. These will help me provide solutions to a wider variety of complex technical issues without needing close supervision.

I am also working on improving my discretion and impact by taking more ownership of end-to-end tasks such as leading deployments, validating configuration changes across environments, diagnosing cross-system failures, and documenting repeatable patterns for the team. I plan to volunteer for more medium-scope efforts (such as CI workflow improvements, proxy reliability fixes, and application upgrade cycles) so I can demonstrate the Level 2 expectation of handling assignments with general guidance rather than detailed instruction. Strengthening my communication and follow-through will also help ensure my work consistently supports project milestones.

Finally, to build collaboration skills expected at Level 2, I will continue engaging more with cross-functional teammates working with other application SMEs to better understand their needs and improve the solutions we deliver. I also plan to seek guidance from more senior engineers to grow in architectural thinking and long-term planning. These steps will help me operate more independently, contribute to higher-impact work, and stay on track toward my long-term goal of becoming a Solutions Architect.